

TariffNavigator — Project Cheat Sheet

Everything We've Done (Step by Step)

Project: TariffNavigator **Location:** C:\Projects\TariffNavigator **Owner:** Don Johnson — DJ AI Business Consultant (Syracuse, NY | MBE/DBE)

STEP 1: Initial Claude Code Setup

What we did: Opened Claude Code and ran the first prompt to review the project.

```
powershell

cd C:\Projects\TariffNavigator
npx @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Problem encountered: Claude Code uses a Linux/WSL shell, so Windows paths don't work.

Format	Works?	Example
Windows backslash	NO	C:\Projects\TariffNavigator
WSL mount path	YES	/mnt/c/Projects/TariffNavigator
Escaped backslash	YES	C:\\Projects\\TariffNavigator

Fix: Always use `/mnt/c/Projects/TariffNavigator/` in Claude Code prompts.

STEP 2: Market Research — Tariff Problems

What we did: Researched the real problems businesses face with tariffs in 2025-2026.

Key findings that shaped the product:

- Tariff rates jumped from 2.4% to 18% in under 12 months
- CBP collected \$216B in FY2025 (146% increase from 2024)
- 2,218 trade penalties issued for misclassification
- 80% of tariff costs absorbed by businesses in 2025 — flipping to consumers in 2026
- Small businesses hit first and hardest ("canary in the coal mine")

- Supreme Court reviewing IEEPA tariff legality — ruling expected 2026
- USMCA up for renegotiation July 2026
- Tariff stacking confusion (232 + 301 + IEEPA + AD/CVD layering)
- No affordable tools exist for small businesses (enterprise tools = \$500-2,000/month)

Sources used:

- CNBC — small business tariff impact reporting
- Tax Foundation — tariff economic analysis
- Avalara — 2026 tariff compliance guide
- CNN Business — 2026 tariff cost projections
- Wharton/Penn Budget Model — economic forecasting
- Grant Thornton — business response strategies
- Morgan Lewis — trade law analysis
- American Action Forum — 2025 trade year in review

STEP 3: Product Vision — Six Core Modules

What we did: Defined TariffNavigator as a "Tariff Survival Platform" with six modules.

Module	What It Does
1. Smart Tariff Calculator	Stacked duty rates for any product + country
2. Change Alert System	Real-time notifications when rates change
3. Cost Impact Modeler	Scenario planning and pricing strategy tools
4. Alt. Sourcing Finder	Find lower-tariff countries for same products
5. Compliance Risk Scanner	AI classification review to prevent CBP penalties
6. Export Reports	PDFs, CSVs, shareable dashboards

STEP 4: Enterprise Roadmap Created

File: TariffNavigator_Enterprise_Roadmap.md

Four implementation phases:

- Phase 1 (Weeks 1-4): Foundation & core tariff engine
- Phase 2 (Weeks 5-10): Web GUI with React/Next.js
- Phase 3 (Weeks 11-18): Enterprise features (all 6 modules)
- Phase 4 (Weeks 19-24): Scale, deploy, monetize

Pricing model defined:

Tier	Price	Key Features
Free	\$0/mo	10 lookups, basic search
Pro	\$49/mo	Unlimited lookups, alerts, exports
Enterprise	\$199/mo	Multi-user, compliance scanner, API
Consultant	\$499/mo	White-label, unlimited clients

STEP 5: Pitch Deck Created

File: TariffNavigator_PitchDeck.pptx (10 slides)

Slide	Content
1	Title — branding + MBE/DBE credentials
2	The Problem — hard stats (\$216B, 2.4%→18%, 2,218 penalties)
3	Pain Points — 6 specific business struggles
4	The Solution — 6 module product grid
5	How It Works — 4-step user flow
6	Market Opportunity — 33M+ small businesses, revenue projections
7	Pricing Model — 4 tiers
8	Competitive Advantages — 5 reasons we win
9	Development Roadmap — 4 phases timeline
10	Closing CTA — "Ready to Navigate the Tariff Storm?"

STEP 6: CLAUDE.md Build Specification Created

File: `CLAUDE.md` — Drop in `C:\Projects\TariffNavigator\`

This is the master build spec that Claude Code reads automatically. Contains:

- Complete database schema (all tables, columns, types, relationships)
- All API endpoints (auth, tariff, watchlists, catalog, sourcing, compliance, exports, admin)
- Tech stack decisions (FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Next.js, Shadcn/UI, Claude API)
- Branding colors and standards
- Code quality requirements
- Phase-by-phase implementation tasks with exit criteria

STEP 7: Claude Code Build Prompts Created

File: `CLAUDE_CODE_BUILD_PROMPTS.md`

Five sequential prompts to paste into Claude Code:

Prompt	What It Builds
Step 1: Project Setup	Folder structure, FastAPI app, .env, dependencies, middleware
Step 2: Database Models	All SQLAlchemy models, Alembic migration, table creation
Step 3: Auth System	JWT auth (register, login, refresh, roles, middleware)
Step 4: Tariff Engine	Core stacking algorithm, AI classifier, seed data, API endpoints
Step 5: Verification	Health check, full test, progress tracking
Phase 2 Kickoff	Next.js frontend with dashboard (use after Phase 1 verified)

TESTING URLs

Once the backend is running (`uvicorn app.main:app --reload`), test at:

Endpoint	URL	Method
Health Check	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/health</code>	GET
API Docs (Swagger)	<code>http://localhost:8000/docs</code>	GET (browser)
API Docs (ReDoc)	<code>http://localhost:8000/redoc</code>	GET (browser)
Register	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/auth/register</code>	POST
Login	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/auth/login</code>	POST
My Profile	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/auth/me</code>	GET (with JWT)
Tariff Lookup	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/lookup</code>	POST (with JWT)
AI Classify	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/classify</code>	POST (with JWT)
HTS Code Detail	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/hts/{code}</code>	GET (with JWT)
Active Programs	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/programs</code>	GET (with JWT)
Watchlists	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/watchlists</code>	GET (with JWT)
Alerts	<code>http://localhost:8000/api/alerts</code>	GET (with JWT)

Once frontend is running (`npm run dev` from frontend/):

Page	URL
Dashboard	<code>http://localhost:3000</code>
Login	<code>http://localhost:3000/login</code>
Register	<code>http://localhost:3000/register</code>
Tariff Search	<code>http://localhost:3000/search</code>
Watchlists	<code>http://localhost:3000/watchlists</code>
Cost Modeler	<code>http://localhost:3000/modeler</code>
Alerts	<code>http://localhost:3000/alerts</code>
Settings	<code>http://localhost:3000/settings</code>

QUICK TEST COMMANDS (curl)

Register a user:

```
bash

curl -X POST http://localhost:8000/api/auth/register \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email":"don@djai.com","password":"testpass123","name":"Don Johnson","company_name":"DJ AI Business Consulta
```

Login:

```
bash

curl -X POST http://localhost:8000/api/auth/login \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"email":"don@djai.com","password":"testpass123"}'
```

Tariff Lookup (replace YOUR_TOKEN):

```
bash
```

```
curl -X POST http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/lookup \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN" \
-d '{"product_description":"steel rebar","country_code":"CN"}'
```

AI Classification (replace YOUR_TOKEN):

```
bash

curl -X POST http://localhost:8000/api/tariff/classify \
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \
-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_TOKEN" \
-d '{"description":"stainless steel bolts and fasteners for construction"}'
```

Health Check:

```
bash

curl http://localhost:8000/api/health
```

FILES DELIVERED

File	Purpose	Location
CLAUDE.md	Master build spec for Claude Code	Drop in C:\Projects\TariffNavigator\
CLAUDE_CODE_BUILD_PROMPTS.md	Step-by-step build prompts	Reference doc — paste from it
TariffNavigator_Enterprise_Roadmap.md	Business roadmap document	For planning/investors
TariffNavigator_PitchDeck.pptx	10-slide pitch deck	For investor/client meetings

GIT BASICS

Command	What It Does
<code>git status</code>	See what's changed
<code>git add .</code>	Stage all changes

Command	What It Does
<code>git commit -m "message"</code>	Save changes locally
<code>git push origin master</code>	Upload to GitHub
<code>git pull origin master</code>	Download latest from GitHub
<code>git log --oneline</code>	See commit history

"Your branch is 1 commit ahead of origin/master" = You have local changes not yet pushed to GitHub. Run `git push origin master` to sync.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

1. Drop `CLAUDE.md` into `C:\Projects\TariffNavigator\`
 2. Open PowerShell: `cd C:\Projects\TariffNavigator`
 3. Launch Claude Code: `npx @anthropic-ai/claude-code`
 4. Paste **Step 1** from `CLAUDE_CODE_BUILD_PROMPTS.md`
 5. Verify it runs clean
 6. Paste **Step 2**, verify, continue through Step 5
 7. After Phase 1 is solid, paste the **Phase 2 Kickoff** prompt
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